Programme Schedule

The 2nd Global Biennial Summit for African Art & Culture

Chasing The Wind While Losing Daylight

21–22 October 2026 · Ibadan, Nigeria

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With the kind support of

Day One- *Encountering Space*

October 21st, Wednesday

New Culture Studios

2:00–3:00 PM | Arrival and Registration
Arrival of participants and registration.

3:00–4:30 PM | Encountering New Culture
A guided tour of New Culture Studios with Rufus Nwoko, exploring its architecture, history, ideas, and place within Ibadan's cultural landscape.

4:30–5:00 PM | Break

5:00–6:15 PM | The Beginning
A stage play adapted and directed by Rufus Nwoko.

6:15 PM onwards | Refreshments and Fellowship
An informal gathering to meet, reconnect, and share conversations.

Day Two- *Conversation Circles*

October 22nd, Thursday
New Culture Studios

9:00–9:55 AM | Arrival, Registrations and Breakfast

9:55–10:15 AM | Official Opening
Welcome remarks, opening address by Chris Udoh, and an introduction to the theme and curatorial direction of the Summit.

10:15 AM–12:15 PM | Conversation Circle I
CAN A RIVER FORGET ITS SOURCE?
Memory, authorship and what remains.
Conversation Guide: **Rufus Nwoko**

A conversation on restitution, reparation, indigenous knowledge, cultural memory and African creative agency.

12:15–1:15 PM | Lunch

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1:15–3:15 PM | Conversation Circle II
THE PURGE
Re-indigenising the African imagination.
Conversation Guide: **Jumoke Sanwo**

An examination of the ideas, values and inherited frameworks that shape how we understand art, education, success, institutions, funding and ourselves.

3:15–3:45 PM | Break

3:45–5:45 PM | Conversation Circle III
THE MAKING OF OUR MANILLA II
Building what can sustain us.
Conversation Guide: **Kemi Ilesanmi**

A conversation on African philanthropy, patronage, collecting, investment, cultural entrepreneurship and the institutions and relationships needed to sustain African art and culture.

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6:00–6:30 PM | In The Quiet of My Noise

A guest artistic performance by **Babatunde OlorunJedalo,** which invites us into a space where silence and disturbance coexist.

6:40–7:00 PM | Closing Remarks

From Conversation to Building

Reflections on the day's conversations, what remains unresolved, and what we can begin to build together beyond the Summit.

***7*:00 PM onwards | Fellowship and Departure**

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Chasing The Wind While Loosing Daylight

Curatorial Text By **Chris Udoh**

Oh, what a waste of daylight it is to move through the world chasing the wind while losing sight of the beauty of everything it touches around us.

For the **2nd edition of the Global Biennial Summit of African Art and Culture**, the theme, *Chasing the Wind While Losing Daylight*, asks us to question the direction of our energy.

For decades, we have demanded restitution, called for reparation, named the violence of erasure, and insisted on the return of what was taken. This insistence has been necessary. It has been dignified. It has been just.

And yet in the midst of it all, we must ask: at what cost does a struggle remain outward-facing? How long can we organize our becoming around the recognition of former powers?

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"I have seen all the works that are done under the sun; and behold, all is vanity and a chasing after wind." — ***Ecclesiastes 1:14, The Holy Bible***

The ancient lament above warns us against a kind of exhaustion that engulfs us when we pour daylight into pursuits that never culminate in wholeness.

Restitution, reparation, decolonization - as they are often framed- require response. They require acknowledgement. They require the former colonizer to concede, to sign, to certify, to return. In this structure, our restoration remains tethered to external validation. Our wholeness is postponed, pending approval.

But can liberation that waits still be called liberation?

Frantz Fanon reminds us in his 1961 book, *The Wretched of the Earth*, that each generation must discover its mission. Perhaps ours is no longer only to retrieve fragments of the past, but to remember that the source from which they emerged is inexhaustible.

The power was never contained in the things lost. It lived, and still very much lives, in our cosmologies, languages and land-based knowledge systems. It lives in our rituals, in our rhythm and in memory-keeping traditions that cannot be looted. What was taken were just expressions of who we are, but what remains is origin.

So why then, why are we chasing sticks when we are the trees? Why seek buckets of water when we are the ocean itself?

Chasing is exhausting. It narrows the horizon to a single point - the thing taken, the thing withheld, the thing owed. It convinces us that wholeness lies elsewhere. It fixes our gaze on the hand that removed, rather than the hand that still creates.

And while we chase, daylight fades.

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“The river is everywhere at once... the present only exists for it.”-

Hermann Hesse (Siddhartha, 1992)

Pan-African thought has always understood circularity. That the river does not argue for its existence but flows and that seeds do not petition the soil but root. So also, regeneration cannot be negotiated but enacted.

Reindigenization proposes a similar movement. It is cyclical and reorders imagination around renewal rather than grievance. It turns inward and downward - toward soil, toward memory systems that survived erasure, toward cosmologies that were never fully extractable. It restores reciprocity between culture and ecology - language and land, ritual and season, body and territory. It is creation without permission. Culture enacted so fully that validation becomes peripheral.

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This biennial makes space for an honest, courageous dialogue about the ways we may have over-identified with victimhood, how we cling to our wounds so tightly that we forget our capacity to heal. It seeks to propose practical ways, not just thoughts, of how we can channel our energies towards re-indigenizing our spaces, practices and rhythms.

If we are truly the origin- if the river flows from us - why don't we simply create again?

Can any people truly be "decolonized" by external action alone? And if a glass of water is clouded with sand, must we pick out each grain- or can we simply fill it with fresh water until clarity returns?

These are questions of possibility sitting at the very center of our collective contemplation for this gathering.

Thank you for sharing space with us.

May Our Eyes Never Be Shut In Life or Death!

Global Biennial Summit for African Art & Culture 2026

Chasing The Wind While Losing Daylight

Ibadan, October 21 - 22, 2026